Handoff 28: Docs sync after PRs #24 to #32 (master run S01, DOCS-SYNC)

Date: 2026-11-02 (America/Toronto)
Written by: Claude Code (implementer), in a separate git worktree
For: the human maintainer, and ChatGPT or Claude chat (reviewer) without repository access
Status: **in_review**: one pull request (#33), documentation only, not merged. Nothing was marked `verified`.

> **How to use this file:** upload it with `docs/plan/backlog.md`, `docs/plan/decision-log.md`, `docs/run-log.md` and `README.md`. The pull request diff is the source of truth (`build.md` section 14).

Starter prompt for the chat assistant

```
You are reviewing a documentation-only update to Python Academy, stage S01 of
docs/plan/master-run.md. I'm attaching the backlog, the decision log, the run
log, the README and this handoff. Check that nothing is marked verified or
"decided" without a source, that the status words are build.md's (proposed,
ready, in_progress, in_review, verified, blocked, deferred), and that chapters
18 to 22 of the decision log say only what handoffs 22 and 24 to 27 say.
```

Run plan details

Field	Value
Stage	S01, DOCS-SYNC
Base	`main`, at `4b70a28`. No other PR needs to merge first
Part 2 boxes relied on	**None. No box is ticked.** "Add every ID from Part 9 below as `proposed`" and every other S01 item that has no box were done. B-U3 is empty, so `course-catalog.md` section 6.2 was not touched

1. Step 0 (checks before editing)

The result is in `docs/run-log.md`, section "S00". In short: #32 is open and unmerged; every PR the plan names as merged is merged; and the plan's list of gaps was too short in several places, listed there.

2. Handoff record (build.md template)

Field	Value
Task	Make `backlog.md`, `decision-log.md`, the stage table and the README match reality. Add the master run plan and the run log
Human goal	Anyone reading the repository, including a chat assistant, sees the true state, with nothing claimed that nobody checked
Repository and branch	`torontojohn/python-academy`, branch `docs/backlog-sync-3`
Non-goals	Any code; any answer to an owner question; `course-catalog.md` section 6.2 (B-U3 is empty); corrections to the master run file
Data and compatibility	None. Documentation only; commits carry `[skip render]`
Deployment status	Not requested

Files changed

File	Why
`docs/plan/master-run.md`	The plan, unchanged, as its own first commit. It matches `MASTER-RUN.md` byte for byte
`docs/run-log.md` (new)	Stage statuses and the S00 differences
`docs/plan/backlog.md`	Stage table rows 16 to 28; live checks with their PRs; statuses; new rows; the ID-01 answers
`docs/plan/decision-log.md`	Chapters 18 to 22; the table "Open, awaiting the owner"; the index
`README.md`	Units released, near-term work, and browser-check facts
`docs/handoffs/2026-11-02-28-docs-sync-3.md` and `.pdf`	This handoff

3. What changed in the backlog

Row	Change
FB-02, FB-04, ENG-04b, ASSESS-08, UI-05, ENG-03, DOC-01, DOC-02, SITE-01	Now `in_review: merged`, with PR, handoff and the live check owed
EDU-04	`in_review`: lessons merged. The unit check and unit project are not built, so the row says so
EDU-03	`in_review`, part 1 only: #32 open. Part 2 not started
ID-01	Updated with the owner's three answers from plan section 10

Row	Change
ID-01a to ID-01f, SEC-10, SEC-11	Added exactly as `independent-learners.md` section 10 names them
ASSESS-06	The onboarding addition from plan section 10
ENG-04c	Added, as handoff 19 asked
README-01	Added. The plan expected this row to exist already
ENG-06 to ENG-11, PROJ-01, QA-03	Added as `proposed`, with priority "—", because Part 9 gives none. None clashes with `build.md` section 13

4. Decisions and why

Decision	Options considered	Reason	Who decided
Stage table also gets rows 16 to 19	Only rows 20 to 27, as the plan says	The table stopped at 15. Leaving a gap would keep it false	Implementer (**assumption 1**)
A chapter for handoff 24 too	Only 22, 26 and 27, as the plan says	Handoff 24 section 11 asks for one, and without it the log skips the first real lessons	Implementer (**assumption 2**)
Handoff 23 gets no chapter	Add one	The plan does not ask, and its section 10 asks for none. Its open questions are in the open table	Implementer
The ID-01 answers are chapter 20, unnumbered in the backlog's decision table	Give them numbers 28 to 30	Numbering them would be my invention. The owner can number them	Implementer (**assumption 3**)
Row 21 reads "reserved, never ran"	Leave the number out	The plan says the gap stays. A row explains why it exists	Implementer
No backlog row for construct rule IDs	Invent an ID	Plan section 1.6 forbids inventing the naming. It is in the open table	Implementer
No backlog row for the worker fix	Add one	Handoff 27 asks this as a question, and the owner has not answered	Implementer
`DOC-03`, `EDU-11` and `PORT-01` not added	Add them	Not in Part 9, and handoffs 16 and 18 found no such items	Implementer
README screenshot left as it is	Retake it	The catalog picture shows "1 of 12 units open", and its alt text describes that picture truthfully. Retaking it is outside this stage's text	Implementer (**assumption 4**)

Decision	Options considered	Reason	Who decided
PR #32 named as plain text in the README	A link	The repository is private, so a link answers 404 to anyone signed out	Implementer

5. Bugs found and how they were fixed

No code changed. Stale facts found and fixed: the stage table stopped at 15; FB-02, ENG-04b and ASSESS-08 said `proposed` although merged; the backlog's `UI-05` and `FB-04` rows were out of date; the README called browser checks a future thing.

Near-miss: my first draft of the README said "unit projects beyond unit 1's". Nothing in the repository establishes a unit 1 project (the plan's own S23 says to check first), so it now says the mechanism is not built.

Near-miss: my first draft of the new rows used "Proposed by the master run" as a priority. Backlog section 8, row 11 already rejected a non-standard priority word; these rows now use "—".

6. How it was tested

Check	Method	Result
Links, images and anchors	A script reads every Markdown link and every `href` and `src` in the README, backlog, decision log and run log, and checks files and GitHub heading anchors	**45 local links, 0 problems**
Tables	The same script counts the columns in each table row	**625 rows, 0 problems**
IDs and status words	Every row in backlog section 5: no duplicate ID, the status starts with a `build.md` section 18 word, and the required IDs exist. New IDs were searched for in `build.md`	**91 rows, 0 problems; no clash**
Plan copied unchanged	`cmp MASTER-RUN.md docs/plan/master-run.md`	Identical
Backend, SQLite	`cd backend && DATABASE_URL=sqlite:///<temp>.db ../../python-academy/backend/.venv/bin/python -m pytest -q`	**541 passed, 11 skipped**
Backend, PostgreSQL 16	Same with `TEST_POSTGRES_URL=<local pgserver>`	**552 passed**
Frontend	`cd frontend && npx tsc --noEmit && npm run build && CI=1 npx playwright test`	Types and build OK; **173 passed**

The suites prove this change broke nothing. They say nothing about the documents' content, which is reviewed by reading it. **Mocks:** none added. **Deliberate-break controls:** none; a documentation stage uses

the checks above instead (plan section 1.8).

7. Known limitations

- **The README's first screenshot is out of date:** it shows "1 of 12 units open", and the live count is 2.
- **The status words hold until the next merge.** If #32 merges, its rows need updating; the next sync does that.
- **Chapter 22 describes an unmerged PR,** and says so at its top.
- **The run log will conflict.** Without chaining, each run PR from `main` adds its own copy of `docs/run-log.md`, so a second PR conflicts once the first merges. It affects that one file: keep the copy with the most rows. Or ask Claude Code to refresh the remaining branches after a merge.

8. Live checks for you

None. Nothing a user can see has changed. The list of checks still owed is in `backlog.md` section 1.

9. Questions for you

Each recommendation is **recommended, not yet confirmed**.

1. **Was Part 2 meant to be empty?** Every box is empty, including B-R1 (chaining). So S02, S06 to S09 and every gated stage were skipped. *Recommended: tick the boxes you accept, then run the same prompt again. B-R1, B-R2 and B-U3 unblock the most work. SEC-10 is the most urgent check regardless.*
2. **Assumptions 1 to 4 above.** *Recommended: accept all four.*
3. `DOC-03`, `EDU-11` **and** `PORT-01`**:** Part 4 of the plan treats them as IDs, but earlier handoffs found no such items, and `EDU-11` was a discarded draft ID. *Recommended: use* `DOC-03` *for the book outline if you want a row, and drop the other two.*
4. **FB-05 and FB-06 order:** the plan's S18 says the button never ships before the inbox, while the backlog's FB-06 row depends on FB-05. *Recommended: change the FB-06 row to depend on FB-03 and SEC-03 only, and FB-05 on FB-06.*
5. **S21's name:** the plan calls it "ASSESS-06 and ID-01e", but ID-01e is the invited group. *Recommended: call it ASSESS-06 alone.*

10. For the docs sync

This is the docs sync. Rows to add next time: this PR's merge, and any stage from `docs/run-log.md`.

11. Next concrete action

Answer question 1, then merge in any order. See section 7 for the run log.

12. Removing the worktree safely

From the **main** folder, after this PR is merged:

```
cd /Users/DEV/Projects/python-academy
git -C ../python-academy-sync3 status --short   # expect nothing, or only ??
frontend/AGENTS.md
rm -f ../python-academy-sync3/frontend/AGENTS.md   # generated by Next.js, not part of the
project
git worktree remove ../python-academy-sync3     # deletes only that folder; refuses if
anything is uncommitted
git worktree prune
git branch -d docs/backlog-sync-3               # refuses if the branch is not merged
```

Don't delete the folder in the Finder or with `rm -rf`; Git would keep a stale record of it (`git worktree prune` fixes that).